

GRIDIRON-60

The GridIron-60 program — built for the serious 60+ lifter who refuses to slow down. — tempo prescriptions, pyramid loading, drop sets, and joint-safe exercise selection for the serious 60+ lifter.

MON		WED	THU	FRI		SUN
CHEST		BACK	LEGS	ARMS		SHOULDERS
Day 1		Day 2	Day 3	Day 4		Day 5

TEMPO KEY: 3s ECCENTRIC = lower slowly over 3 seconds

1-2s HOLD = squeeze at peak contraction

PYRAMID = add weight each set

DROP SET = finish last set with 2-3 weight drops × 8 reps

GRIDIRON-60 — V4

// OPTIMIZED FOR THE 60+ LIFTER • BEST OF BOTH PLANS

01

CHEST

~80 MIN

PUSH DAY • CABLE PRE-
EXHAUST + COMPOUND •
MONDAY (OR ANY TRAINING
DAY)

// CARDIO WARM-UP



STATIONARY BIKE — 15 MIN

0–5 min: Easy RPE 4 • 5–12 min: Moderate RPE 5–6, ~120
bpm • 12–15 min: Easy wind-down

// SHOULDER + CHEST PRE-EXHAUST WARM-UP



SHOULDER WARM-UP CIRCUIT + JOINT PREP

Band pull-aparts × 20 • Then with 2–3 kg DBs, no rest
between: Lateral raise × 20 → Rear delt fly × 20 → Front
raise × 20 (2 rounds). Then 1 light cable fly set × 15 (pre-
exhaust, very light).

// WORKING SETS

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	TEMPO	REST	VI
Incline Dumbbell Press <i>30° incline; pyramid up each set</i>  3-sec lower • 1-sec pause	4 × 12-10-8-8	2.5 min	2.5 min	▶

at chest • 1-sec press 🏋️ Set 1 light (RPE 6) → Set 4 heavy (RPE 8) Primary				
Machine Chest Press <i>Fixed path; replaces flat barbell – safer for shoulders at 60+</i> 🕒 3-sec lower • 1-sec pause • 1-sec press 🏋️ Pyramid up. RPE 8 on final set. Joint-Smart	3 × 12-10-8	2 min	2 min	▶
Cable Fly (Low-to-High) <i>Bring handles together in front; squeeze hard for 1 sec; lower in 3 sec</i> 🕒 3-sec lower • 1-sec peak contraction squeeze • 1-sec up 🏋️ Light isolation – RPE 7 at rep 12	3 × 12	90 sec	90 sec	▶

Isolation				
Dumbbell Pullover <i>Slight elbow bend; full stretch at top; feel chest and serratus</i>  3-sec lower to stretch · 1-sec hold at stretch · 1-sec return  Light – this is a stretch movement, RPE 6 max Finisher	3 × 12	90 sec	90 sec	▶

// COOL-DOWN

Doorway pec stretch × 45 sec · Cross-body shoulder stretch × 40 sec each · 10 deep breaths

02

BACK

PULL DAY · WIDTH & THICKNESS · WEDNESDAY (OR ANY TRAINING DAY)

~80 MIN

// CARDIO WARM-UP



STATIONARY BIKE — 15 MIN

0–5 min: Easy RPE 4 • 5–12 min: Moderate RPE 5–6 • 12–15 min: Wind-down

// BACK & SHOULDER PREP



5 MIN PREP

Dead hang 2 × 20 sec • Cat-cow × 10 • Band face pulls × 20 •
2 warm-up sets cable pullover (very light) • 2 warm-up sets
lat pulldown at 40% and 60%.

// WORKING SETS

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	TEMPO	REST	VI
Cable Pullover (Opener) <i>Straight arms; feel lats stretching and contracting; great activation</i>  3-sec lower • 1-sec squeeze at bottom • 1- sec return  Light opener — RPE 6. Focus entirely on lat feel. Added Exercise	3 × 10	90 sec	90 sec	

Lat Pulldown (Wide Grip) <i>Pull to upper chest; full stretch at top; lean back 10°; pyramid up</i>  3-sec return to top · 1-sec squeeze at chest · 1-sec pull  Pyramid: set 1 RPE 6 → set 4 RPE 8 Primary	4 × 12-10-8-8	2.5 min	2.5 min	▶
Seated Cable Row (Close Grip) <i>Body at 90° — don't lean back; drive elbows to stomach; hold 2 sec</i>  3-sec return · 2-sec hold at stomach · 1-sec pull  Flat sets at working weight. RPE 7-8 across all sets. Primary	4 × 12	2.5 min	2.5 min	▶
Single-Arm Dumbbell Row <i>Brace on bench; full</i>	4 × 12-10-8-6	2 min	2 min	▶

range; pyramid up each set  3-sec lower • 1-sec pause at top • 1-sec row  Pyramid: 12-10-8-6 growing weight Unilateral				
Hammer Strength High Row <i>Drive elbows back; squeeze shoulder blades together at end</i>  3-sec return • 1-sec squeeze • 1-sec pull  Moderate — RPE 7 at rep 12. Great mid-back thickness builder. Added Exercise	3 × 12	2 min	2 min	▶
Face Pulls (Cable Rope) <i>External rotate at end — critical for rotator cuff health; Essential at 60+</i>  2-sec return • 1-sec hold at face • 1-sec	3 × 20	90 sec	90 sec	▶

pull

⚙️ **Very light.**

**RPE 5-6. Health
work, not ego
work.**

Shoulder Health

// COOL-DOWN

Child's pose × 45 sec • Lat overhead stretch × 30 sec • Supine
spinal twist × 30 sec each • Bicep wall stretch × 30 sec each

03

LEGS — COMPLETE

~90 MIN

FULL LOWER BODY • PYRAMID
LOADING + DROP SET •
THURSDAY (OR ANY TRAINING
DAY)

// CARDIO WARM-UP



STATIONARY BIKE — 15 MIN

0-5 min: Easy RPE 3-4 • **5-12 min:** Higher resistance RPE
6 — directly warms quads, hamstrings, glutes • **12-15 min:**
Easy spin

// HIP & KNEE PREP



5 MIN PREP

Leg swings × 15 each direction • Glute bridge × 15 • Hip circles × 10 • 2 warm-up sets leg extension (very light) • 2 warm-up sets leg press at 40% and 60%.

// WORKING SETS

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	TEMPO	REST
Leg Extension (Opener — Their Technique) <i>Start light and pyramid up; hold contraction 1 sec at top; 3-sec lower</i> 3-sec lower • 1-sec squeeze at top • 1-sec lift Set 1 very light (RPE 5) → Set 5 challenging (RPE 8). Pre- exhausts quads before press. Their Technique	5 × 15-12-10-10-8	90 sec	90 sec

Leg Press + Final Drop Set <i>Pyramid up; final set: do 8 reps → drop weight 30% → 8 more → drop → 8 more</i>  3-sec lower · 1-sec pause at bottom · 1-sec press (don't lock out)  Set 1 moderate (RPE 6) → Set 4 hard (RPE 8) → Drop set to failure protocol Primary · Their Drop Set	4 × 12-10-8-8+drop	3 min	3 min
Romanian Deadlift <i>Hip hinge; push hips back; feel hamstring stretch; controlled descent</i>  3-sec lower · 1-sec hold at stretch · 1-sec return	4 × 10-12	3 min	3 min

⚠️ Build to RPE 7-8 by set 3. Start lighter than you think. Primary • Hamstrings				
Seated Leg Curl (Growing Weight) <i>Add weight each set; full range; 2-sec hold at peak contraction</i> 🕒 3-sec return • 2-sec squeeze at peak • 1-sec curl ⚠️ Start conservative — pyramid up each set. Final set RPE 8. Their Variation	4 × 10 (growing)	2 min	2 min	
Hip Thrust <i>Squeeze glutes hard at top; chin tucked; hold 1 sec</i> 🕒 2-sec lower • 1-sec	4 × 12	2 min	2 min	

squeeze at top · 1-sec drive 🕒 RPE 7 at rep 12 across all sets. Glutes			
Adductor Machine + 10-Sec Hold <i>After each set: hold the closed position for 10 seconds – their technique, excellent for stability</i> 🕒 Controlled throughout · 10-sec isometric hold at end of each set 🕒 Start light – RPE 5-6. The 10-sec hold makes it significantly harder. Their Technique	4 × 12 + 10s hold	90 sec	90 sec
Standing Calf	4 × 15	60 sec	60 sec

Raise

Full range: all the way up, 1-sec hold at top, 3-sec lower



3-sec lower · 1-sec hold at top · 1-sec rise

⚠ Calves need RPE 8 by rep 15 or they won't grow.

Calves

// COOL-DOWN

Standing quad stretch × 45 sec each · Pigeon pose × 60 sec each · Lying hamstring stretch × 60 sec each · Foam roll quads & hamstrings × 3 min

04

ARMS

~85 MIN

BICEPS · TRICEPS ·
FOREARMS · SATURDAY – TWO
REST DAYS AFTER LEGS

// CARDIO WARM-UP



STATIONARY BIKE — 15 MIN

0–5 min: Easy RPE 4 • 5–12 min: Moderate RPE 5–6, raises elbow joint temperature • 12–15 min: Wind-down

// ELBOW & WRIST PREP



5 MIN PREP

Wrist circles × 20 each direction • Elbow flexion/extension no weight × 15 • Light EZ-bar curl × 15 (bar only) • Light tricep pushdown × 15 • Forearm stretch × 30 sec each side.

// WORKING SETS — TRICEPS FIRST

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	TEMPO	REST	VI
Tricep Rope Pushdown <i>Elbows pinned to sides; flare rope at bottom; squeeze hard 2 sec</i> 🕒 3-sec return • 2-sec squeeze at bottom • 1-sec push 🔊 RPE 7 at rep 12 across all sets. Triceps	4 × 12	2 min	2 min	▶
EZ-Bar Lying Extension <i>Replaces skull crushers — same movement, EZ-bar angle protects wrists and elbows at 60+; elbows stay in throughout</i>	4 × 12	2 min	2 min	▶

 3-sec lower to forehead · 1-sec pause · 1-sec extend  Start very light – this loads the elbow joint directly. RPE 7 at rep 12. Joint-Smart Skull Crusher				
Overhead Cable Tricep Extension <i>Rope; full stretch overhead; 3-sec lower – long head emphasis</i>  3-sec lower to stretch · 1-sec pause · 1-sec extend  Lighter than pushdown. RPE 7 by rep 12. Triceps Long Head	3 × 12	90 sec	90 sec	►
Tricep Dip Machine <i>Squeeze triceps hard for 2 sec at full extension; upright torso</i>  3-sec return · 2-sec squeeze at bottom · 1-sec push  RPE 7-8 at rep 12. If shoulder discomfort, use bench dip instead. Triceps	3 × 12	2 min	2 min	►

// WORKING SETS – BICEPS

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	TEMPO	REST	VI
EZ-Bar Curl <i>Full range; no swinging; EZ-bar protects wrists</i>  3-sec lower · 1-sec squeeze at top · 1-sec curl  RPE 7 at rep 10. Never swing — tempo prevents it. Biceps	4 × 10-12	2 min	2 min	▶
Incline Dumbbell Curl <i>Supinate at top; squeeze 2 sec; lower in 3 sec — their tempo exactly</i>  3-sec lower · 2-sec squeeze at top · 1-sec curl  ~30% lighter than EZ-bar. Stretched position is harder than it looks. Biceps Long Head	4 × 10	90 sec	90 sec	▶
Preacher Curl <i>Full range; eliminates cheating; great peak contraction — their addition</i>  3-sec lower · 1-sec squeeze at top · 1-sec curl  Lighter than	3 × 12	90 sec	90 sec	▶

standing curl – the pad removes body English. RPE 7 at rep 12. Added Exercise				
Hammer Curl <i>Neutral grip; targets brachialis for arm thickness</i>  3-sec lower · 1-sec pause · 1-sec curl  Similar weight to regular curl. Controlled tempo throughout. Brachialis	3 × 12	90 sec	90 sec	▶
Reverse Curl <i>Overhand grip; forearm extensors and brachioradialis – not in their plan but important for elbow health</i>  3-sec lower · 1-sec pause · 1-sec curl  Much lighter than regular curl. RPE 6-7. Forearms / Elbow Health	3 × 15	90 sec	90 sec	▶

// COOL-DOWN

Bicep wall stretch × 40 sec each • Tricep overhead stretch × 30 sec each • Forearm flexor stretch × 30 sec each • Forearm extensor stretch × 30 sec each

05

SHOULDERS & ABS

~85 MIN

OVERHEAD PUSH • EXPANDED
CORE WORK • SUNDAY (OR
ANY TRAINING DAY)

// CARDIO WARM-UP



STATIONARY BIKE — 15 MIN

0–5 min: Easy RPE 3–4 • 5–12 min: Moderate RPE 5–6 •
12–15 min: Wind-down

// SHOULDER WARM-UP CIRCUIT



SHOULDER CIRCUIT — NO REST BETWEEN EXERCISES

With 2–3 kg DBs, 2 rounds × 20 reps each, no rest
between: **Lateral raise** → **Rear delt fly** → **Front raise**. Then
YTW with 2.5 lb plates × 12 • Band pull-aparts × 25 •
External rotation band × 15 each.

// WORKING SETS — SHOULDERS

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	TEMPO	REST	VI

Seated Dumbbell Shoulder Press <i>Seated for spinal support; pyramid up; never behind-the-neck</i>  3-sec lower • 1-sec pause at ear level • 1-sec press  Pyramid: set 1 RPE 6 → set 4 RPE 8 Primary	4 × 12-10-8-8	2.5 min	2.5 min	▶
Cable Lateral Raise <i>Slight forward lean; lead with elbow; 1-sec hold at shoulder height</i>  3-sec lower • 1-sec hold at top • 1-sec raise  Most people use 5-15 lb. Lighter than ego wants. RPE 7 at rep 15. Side Delts	4 × 15	90 sec	90 sec	▶
Reverse Pec Deck (Rear Delt) <i>Arms slightly bent;</i>	3 × 15	90 sec	90 sec	▶

<i>lead with elbows; don't shrug traps</i>  3-sec return • 1-sec squeeze open • 1-sec open  Posture work — RPE 6-7. Not a heavy exercise. Posture				
Cable Upright Row (Wide Grip) <i>Elbows to shoulder height only — no higher; stops shoulder impingement</i>  3-sec lower • 1-sec hold at top • 1-sec pull  Stop immediately if you feel shoulder pinching. Form over weight. Joint-Smart	3 × 12	90 sec	90 sec	▶

// WORKING SETS — ABS (EXPANDED FROM THEIR PLAN)

EXERCISE	SETS × REPS	TEMPO	REST	VI

Hanging Leg Lifts <i>From a bar; raise knees to chest or legs straight; controlled throughout – their addition</i>  3-sec lower · 1-sec pause at top · 1-sec raise  Bodyweight. Bend knees if straight-leg is too difficult. Added Exercise	4 × 10-12	60 sec	60 sec	▶
Kneeling Cable Crunch <i>Pull with abs not arms; round the spine; control the return</i>  1-sec crunch · 1-sec hold · 3-sec return  Light enough to feel abs – not neck. Reduce weight if neck tightens. Core	3 × 20	60 sec	60 sec	▶
Reverse Crunches <i>Lower ab emphasis; roll hips up; don't swing – their addition</i>  3-sec lower ·	4 × 10-12	60 sec	60 sec	▶

1-sec pause at top • 1-sec raise 🏠 Bodyweight. Feel it in the lower abs, not the hip flexors. Added Exercise				
Dead Bug <i>Lower back pressed to floor at all times; anti-rotation core stability – not in their plan but essential for 60+</i> 🕒 3-sec extension • 1-sec pause • 1-sec return 🏠 Bodyweight only. Shorten range before adding load. Core Stability	3 × 10 each	60 sec	60 sec	▶

// COOL-DOWN

Cross-body stretch × 45 sec each • Sleeper stretch × 30 sec each • Thoracic extension over foam roller × 2 min • 10 deep breaths

WHAT CHANGED IN V4

// SUMMARY OF MERGES FROM THEIR PLAN

- Tempo added to every exercise — 3-sec negatives, 1-2 sec holds
- Pyramid loading on all compound movements
- Shoulder warm-up circuit on Day 1 and Day 5
- Drop set added to leg press final set
- Leg extension becomes a 5-set opener on leg day (their technique)
- Seated leg curl replaces lying curl — their variation, growing weight
- Adductor 10-sec isometric hold adopted
- Cable pullover opener added to back day
- Hammer Strength high row added to back day
- Preacher curl added to arms day
- Hanging leg lifts and reverse crunches added to abs
- EZ-bar lying extension replaces skull crushers (same movement, safer)

WHAT WAS KEPT OUT

// THEIR EXERCISES NOT ADOPTED & WHY

- Front squats with barbell — spinal compression risk at 60+; leg press covers the stimulus
- Skull crushers — replaced with EZ-bar lying extension; identical movement, safer wrist and elbow angle
- Heavy flat barbell bench — machine press substituted; same stimulus, fixed path protects rotator cuff
- Smith machine overhead press — seated DB press preferred; natural arc of motion, less impingement risk
- Lying cable curls with partials — not adopted; high elbow fatigue on top of an already full bicep day
- Bicep machine (their ex. 8) — hammer curl and reverse curl cover the same ground more efficiently

WHAT MAKES THIS PLAN DIFFERENT

// KEY UPGRADES FROM THE MERGE

- Tempo on every exercise — 3-sec negatives, 1-2 sec holds at peak
- Pyramid loading on all compound movements — grow weight each set

- Shoulder warm-up circuit on chest and shoulder days
- Drop set added to leg press final set
- Leg extension becomes 5-set pyramid opener on leg day
- Seated leg curl replaces lying curl — growing weight each set
- Adductor 10-sec isometric hold after every set
- Cable pullover opener added to back day
- Hammer Strength high row added to back day
- Preacher curl added to arms day
- Hanging leg lifts and reverse crunches added to abs
- EZ-bar lying extension replaces skull crushers — same stimulus, safer joints

RECOVERY RULES

// NON-NEGOTIABLE FOR 60+

- Sleep 7–9 hours — growth hormone peaks during deep sleep
- Tue & Fri are rest days — swap freely, never train 3 days back-to-back

- Arms follow Legs by design — arms arrive fully fresh every session
- Deload every 6–8 weeks: cut weight 40%, keep reps — CNS reset
- 10 min mobility work daily, even on rest days
- Pain vs. soreness: DOMS is fine, joint pain is a stop sign
- Annual bloodwork: testosterone, thyroid, CBC, lipids, Vitamin D
- Rest day activity: 20–30 min easy walking only

**MASTER ATHLETE PROGRAM • 60+ • V4 GRIDIRON-60 PLAN •
COMPARISON VS ATTACHED PROGRAM • CONSULT A PHYSICIAN
BEFORE STARTING ANY NEW TRAINING PROGRAM**